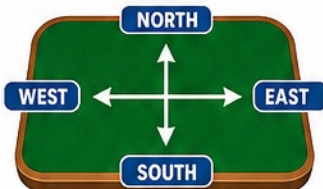


LESSON 5: BROKEN SUITS – HOW TO HANDLE HONORS



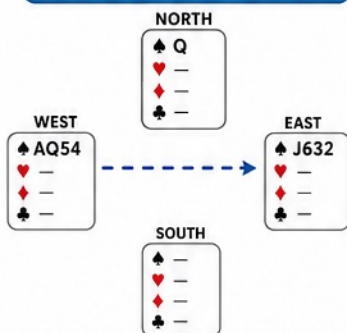
- 1 FIRST TO MOVE
IS AT A DISADVANTAGE:**
play towards honors,
not from them



When you lead from
an honor, you reduce
your chances.
Lead towards honors
to give your hand
the best chance!

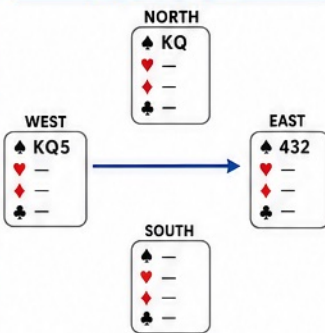
2 SPECIFIC HONORS

1) AQ54 + J632:
finesse towards the Queen



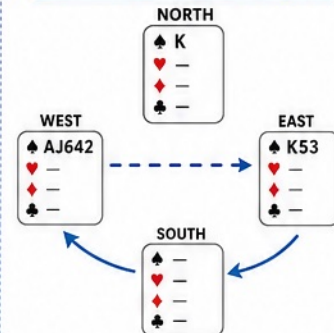
Lead towards the Queen.
If East has the King, the Queen
wins the trick.

2) KQ5 + 432:
play towards KQ



Play towards the King-Queen.
If East has the Ace, your KQ
will score the tricks.

3) AJ642 + K53:
combine finesse and length

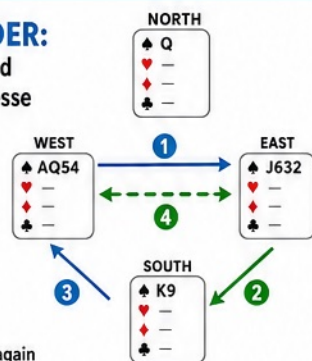


Finesse towards the Jack.
Then use your length to
take the remaining tricks.

3 ENTRY LADDER: entries are needed to repeat the finesse

 You need a way
back to your hand
to try the finesse
again!

- 1 Lead towards the Queen
- 2 Return to hand (entry)
- 3 Lead towards the Queen again
- 4 Repeat until suit is established



4 GOLDEN RULE:

 Missing 1 honor
+ 2-3 small cards = **FINESSE**



 Missing 1 honor
+ only 1 small card = **PLAY HIGH**



6 SUMMARY CHART: WHEN TO FINESSE VS PLAY HIGH

YOUR HAND	OPPONENT LIKELY HOLDS	PLAN	WHY?
Missing 1 honor + 2-3 small cards	Honor (e.g., K or A)	FINESSE	Good chance honor is with the opponent.
Missing 1 honor + only 1 small card	Honor (e.g., K or A)	PLAY HIGH	High chance honor is behind you.
Missing 2+ honors	Unpredictable	PLAY HIGH	Finessing twice is too risky.
Long suit (5+ cards)	Any	Use length + entries	Create extra tricks after establishing suit.

5 PROBE PLAY: play to discover the position of opponents' honors



A probe lead is a small card
played early to learn where
the missing honors are
before committing your
important cards.



PRACTICE, OBSERVE, AND THINK AHEAD.
GOOD DECLARERS MAKE PLANS AND FOLLOW THROUGH!

Maestro Franci